

Lab 1 - Set Up a New AutoCAD Electrical Drawing

Course: Technical Drawing with AutoCAD Electrical (TGS-2023037466) | Topic 01: Introduction to Technical Drawing Using AutoCAD Electrical Maps to: A1 - devise metrics and guidelines for technical drawing production (template, workspace, limits, units)

Goal

Create a new drawing from the ACADISO template, then set the workspace, drawing limits and units - the production metrics every drawing in your organisation should start from.

What you'll build

A correctly configured metric drawing sheet, saved as a reusable baseline for the rest of the course.

Tools: AutoCAD Electrical | ACADISO template | Status bar | Grid & Snap

[!Lab 1 workflow](#)

Starter files (in this folder)

- 1-0_Blank.dwg (source: [PacktPublishing/AutoCAD-2025-Best-Practices-Tips-and-Techniques](#))
- DraftingSettings.dwg (source: [PacktPublishing/Mastering-AutoCAD](#))

Step-by-step

1. Start AutoCAD Electrical and create a new drawing from the ACADISO template (New → acadiso.dwt).

NEW → acadiso.dwt

2. Set the Electrical workspace from the Workspace Switching control on the status bar.

WSCURRENT → Electrical

3. Set the drawing limits to an A3 metric sheet (0,0 to 420,297) and Zoom All to see the full sheet.

LIMITS 0,0 420,297 then ZOOM All

4. Set the units to decimal millimetres with 0 precision (Format → Units).

UNITS → Decimal | 0

5. Turn on Grid (F7) and Snap (F9) from the status bar and open DraftingSettings.dwg to compare a pre-configured sheet.

GRID 10 | SNAP 10

6. Save the drawing as MyBaseline.dwg - this is your production guideline drawing.

SAVEAS MyBaseline.dwg

Test it

ZOOM All shows the full 420×297 sheet, the crosshair snaps in 10 mm increments, and STATUS reports decimal units - your baseline metrics are in force.

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